Submission to Inquiry into the 2025 Election

Committee Secretary
Joint Standing Committee on Electoral Matters
PO Box 6021
Parliament House
Canberra ACT 2600

09 December 2025

Dear Committee Secretary,

My name is Troy Harper; I am a resident of Ipswich in the Federal Electorate of Blair. I volunteered during the 2025 federal election at several booths in Blair during the pre-poll period and on election day handing out how-to-vote cards for the local Blair LNP candidate, Mr Carl Mutzelburg.

I chose to volunteer because I believe that the Blair electorate has been severely under-represented for an extended period by the long-serving incumbent member and that stronger local advocacy was needed for the Ipswich Region.

Across the various locations where I assisted, I witnessed only peaceful and harmonious conduct between volunteers and voters. Volunteers from different parties and campaigns, as well as AEC officials, interacted respectfully with each other and with the public. Voters were able to approach the booths, receive material if they wished, and cast their ballots without obstruction, aggression or intimidation.

What I observed on the ground in Blair is consistent with the broader picture presented in several party and organisational submissions to this inquiry, which acknowledge that the Australian Electoral Commission (AEC) generally managed the 2025 election competently and in line with community expectations. The AEC officials I encountered were professional, courteous and focused on running an orderly process at each booth.

I did not experience or witness the kind of intimidation or hostile conduct that has been reported elsewhere.

I offer this short submission to provide a snapshot from the Blair electorate: an example of a peaceful, well-run local experience, even in a seat where there are strong views about representation and political direction.

I hope these observations help the Committee balance reports of negative behaviour with evidence that many parts of the country experienced an election conducted in a calm and respectful manner.

Yours faithfully,

[redacted]

Troy Harper

Ipswich, Queensland
Electorate of Blair